

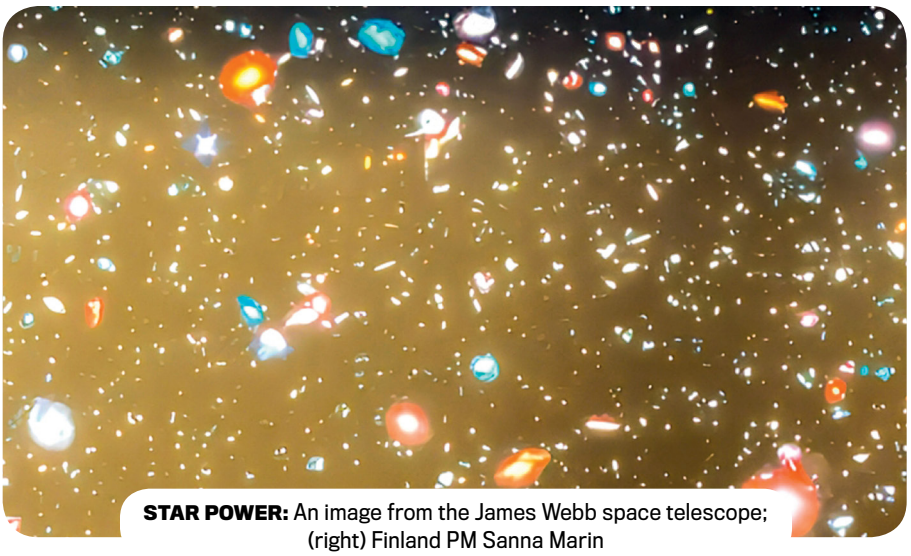
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# The Big Learnings from Davos

**You come here for 'speed dating' with a high net worth.** You come here to find 'capitalist oppressors' and 'Commie conspirators' in equal measure. You come here to see one per cent—or 0.1%—promising to make the world a fairer place... Over the years, the annual summit at Switzerland's picturesque town has been described in many ways.

For me, the best description is an 'ecstasy party of ideas'. It's a place where ideas fly freely, unmindful of class, topic, age, hierarchy, or even feasibility. Here are 12 ideas that I picked in my walkthrough in Davos this year.



**STAR POWER:** An image from the James Webb space telescope; (right) Finland PM Sanna Marin

## 1 GOVERNMENTS BY LOTTERY

The idea of government by lottery now seems attractive, as political systems with elections around the world are seemingly failing. Elected governments can undermine the inner stuffing of democracy by hollowing out institutions. A time-bound government by lottery may be a way to have successful governments without creating an elite and acrimonious environment. Being time-bound, such governments will focus more on governance than on self-preservation.

## 2 NEW FUNDAMENTAL RIGHT: RIGHT TO BRAIN PRIVACY

Your mind is your most private and most free space, where no power can intrude. Right? Perhaps not anymore. Most people are okay with wearable devices that track and record their activity. Call it the quantifiable self. Now, new devices are in the offing that can measure brain activity and provide a dashboard of brain metrics. These measure your brain for alertness and productivity. Employers can't wait, but employees are concerned about these new wearables that can track their activity. Little wonder, they have already been termed "bossware".

In this environment of increasing brain-machine interface, cognitive liberty could be under threat and should become a part of the human rights charter. This will ensure that biometrics is a force that liberates, not oppresses.

Neural signatures (a unique pattern of neural activity associated with a particular task, stimulus, or condition) will be the new passwords of the future.

## 3 STOP COUNTING THE CRISES

We are in a world of polycrisis, where we need solutions that are multilateral and multi-disciplinary. Journalism can't solve the world's problems, but they cannot be solved without journalism for sure.

Many capitalists are cowards who find safe places to sit. But going forward, we need to practise conscious capitalism. Transition industries are the ones to watch out for as they transform from coal to solar, analog to digital, and humans to bots.

## 4 BEST ADVICE TO TRANSFORM YOUR COMPANY

The best way to make things happen in your company is to announce it to the world. That stops internal push and pull and gets teams working towards a common goal. While prioritising, choose things that are at the edge of the impossible. A far-out and big goal but at the same time achievable. Tasks that have some movement on the to-do list and can thus be motivating.

## 5 A NEW LEADER IN SIGHT

The world is seeing a new kind of leadership that is young, bold, female, and unapologetic about being human. I saw it in the session of Finland's prime minister Sanna Marin. She